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Microsoft Word vs. Google Docs

A comprehensive, evidence-backed demonstration document

Positioning thesis

Word provides the real-time collaboration people expect from modern cloud editors while adding deeper professional document production, formal review, rich desktop features, enterprise security, automation, accessibility, and file-format control.

<u>Prepared for</u>	<u>Executive / Sales / IT decision-makers</u>
<u>Prepared by</u>	<u>Microsoft Word capability team</u>
<u>Date</u>	<u>2026-07-03</u>
<u>Document purpose</u>	<u>Prove “all they have plus more” with Word features embedded in this .docx</u>
<u>Status</u>	<u>Draft for review – use Track Changes and comments for sign-off</u>

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Tip: In Word, right-click the Table of Contents and choose “Update Field” to refresh page numbers.

1. Executive summary

Microsoft Word should be positioned as the premium document platform: it matches the cloud collaboration benefits commonly associated with Google Docs, then extends beyond them with mature legal-grade review, long-document production, advanced layout, enterprise-grade protection, automation, accessibility, and integration across Microsoft 365.

3. Capability matrix: Word has all the expected basics plus professional depth

Capability	Google Docs expectation	Microsoft Word answer	Word advantage
Real-time coauthoring	Multiple users edit in a browser	Coauthoring in Word desktop/web when stored in OneDrive/SharePoint	Collaboration with desktop-grade layout and review controls
Comments & mentions	Comments, suggestions, action items	Threaded comments, @mentions, tasks, resolved threads	Integrated with Outlook/Teams/Microsoft 365 identity
Change review	Suggesting mode	Track Changes: insertions, deletions, formatting, reviewer identity, accept/reject, lock tracking	More formal review workflow for legal, editorial, regulated documents
Version history	Restore prior versions	Version history through OneDrive/SharePoint; local file versioning options	Cloud + enterprise repositories + records processes
Long documents	Headings, outline, basic TOC	TOC, captions, cross-references, indexes, bibliography, fields, master-document practices	Better for reports, contracts, manuals, theses
Formatting/design	Basic styles/tables/images	Advanced styles, themes, columns, section breaks, page setup, watermarks, object placement	Higher-fidelity professional output
Mail merge	Requires add-ons/workarounds	Native mail merge with Excel/Outlook data	Production-ready personalized letters, labels, envelopes, email merges
Automation	Apps Script/add-ons	VBA macros, Office Scripts ecosystem, COM/add-ins, Power Automate, content controls	Broader enterprise automation surface
Security/compliance	Drive permissions/admin controls	Purview labels, encryption, DLP, retention/eDiscovery integration, IRM, protected view	Deeper Microsoft 365 governance stack
AI assistance	Gemini/Smart Compose depending on plan	Copilot in Word plus Editor, summaries, drafting, rewrite, M365 grounding where licensed	AI integrated with M365 data and compliance controls
Offline capability	Offline mode after setup	Full desktop application plus offline files synced later	Most capable no-internet document editor
Compatibility	Imports/exports DOCX	Native DOCX fidelity and	Best authoritative format